

aligned and available for your use in real-time. The interface at hand is not very complicated, but it can get cumbersome if your virtual workstation (the on-screen canvas) is not set up the right way.

The best way to start drawing a cartoon character in Adobe Animate is to align all the basic editing tools towards the right of your screen. Animators agree that this is the most ergonomic and hence, comfortable position for right-handed artists. If you're a left-handed artist, you may consider setting up this toolbar on the left-hand pane also. This can be adjusted manually by clicking on the toolbar set and moving it to the left/right pane till it snaps into place. To view or disable this toolbar, you can use the View menu on the top navigation.

A popular method to keep all tools visible without the need to click at the bottom pane (for 'more tools') is to extend the view of the toolbar into two columns. This process saves a lot of time for beginners.

One of the first things that we will do in this tutorial is create a baseline face for our cartoon character. In this tutorial, we are attempting to create an animated version of a girl, for which we will need to start with the Rectangle Primitive Tool – note that this is different from the Rectangle tool, which is usually selected by default. You need to click and hold (long-press) on the Rectangle tool icon to switch this selection.

The next thing that you'll notice is when you select the Rectangle Primitive Tool, you'll see boxes corresponding to "Rectangle Options" under the properties section on the same tab. This tab has numeric values that can be adjusted to change how the corners of a rectangle look. We will be using this feature to create rounded edges – a very common and essential feature of standard cartoon characters. This option also comes with a slider that can be moved sideways to adjust the appearance of the corners. You can move the slider towards the right to create additional curvature for your rectangle shape, and vice-versa. Before you actually create the rectangle, however, it is important for you to select a fill color for the face. We recommend that you select a bright and neutral skin tone for your cartoon's face.

Once you have selected the color, you need to click, hold, and drag the cursor on the canvas area in order to create the basic shape. Notice that the edges (corners) of this "primitive rectangle" shape that you're adding to the canvas will already be refined as per the indicated curvature. You can adjust this curvature even after the shape has been created by first selecting the shape on the canvas (using the pointer tool) and then moving the same slider towards the left (or right) as seen necessary. If you take the slider to